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RECORD 5 MILLION FORCED TO PAY HIGHER RATE TAX

Fury as stealth tax raid punishes middle class strivers – as fears grow Reeves will extend threshold freeze in mini-Budget

THE stealth raid on middle-class workers has pushed the number of higher-rate taxpayers over five million for the first time.

An extra 680,000 people were dragged into the 40 per cent tax bracket compared

By **Jessica Clark**
Senior City Reporter

with a year earlier, according to official figures.

The landmark comes amid fears that Rachel Reeves will extend an 'absurd' earnings threshold freeze in her mini-Budget this month, despite promising no further tax hikes.

Economists said such a move would increase the financial burden for millions, hitting struggling families, and disincentivise hard work.

The latest statistics for 2022/23 are just the 'tip of the iceberg', they warned. The total number of higher-rate taxpayers is on track to hit nine million by 2028

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